

Robert (Bob) Wade

Senior Engineering Manager | Platform & Reliability | Partner & Product | AI-Augmented Operations
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Engineering Manager at Button owning two engineering functions, Core Engineering and Solutions Engineering, and 13 engineers behind \$100B+ in mobile commerce for Amazon, Walmart, Uber, Lyft, Fetch, and Sam's Club. 19 years in engineering, 10+ in management. I take over unstable orgs and leave behind reliable, automated systems: rebuilt on-call to 99.99% uptime, held the platform through a Super Bowl at 2.6x its planned peak with errors flat, and run delivery increasingly on AI-augmented workflows. Also found and run commerce businesses end to end, from engineering and product to brand and design.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership: Multi-function org design, multi-team Agile ceremonies, hiring and bar-setting, coaching and career development, performance management, PERM sponsorship, executive and VP reporting

Platform Reliability: Incident command, on-call and PagerDuty, blameless postmortems, SLAs, observability, peak-load readiness

Partner Engineering: Enterprise integrations, escalation management, attribution and event pipelines, retail media

Product and Delivery: Roadmapping and release planning, backlog and capacity planning, feasibility and scoping gates, cross-functional delivery across product, revenue, and support

Design and UX: Brand and logo design, UI/UX, Figma, front-end build

AI and Automation: Claude and MCP, custom MCP servers, agentic PRD-to-ticket pipelines, generative creative

Backend and Data: Go, Python, Node.js, Postgres, Aurora, MongoDB, BigQuery

Frontend: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Tailwind

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS (ECS, EC2, RDS/Aurora, S3, SES, Route 53), GCP, Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineering Manager, Core Engineering & Solutions Engineering

Button, Inc. | Remote (New York, NY) | October 2020 - Present

Own two engineering functions and 13 direct reports: Core Engineering (routing, attribution, data, infrastructure) and Solutions Engineering (partner delivery and technical escalation), covering the platform behind \$100B+ in driven mobile commerce and routing 130M+ Amazon creator clicks a month across 200+ brands including Amazon, Walmart, Uber, Lyft, Fetch, Target, and Sam's Club.

- Own the core infrastructure Button runs on (routing, decisioning, attribution, and the order pipeline every partner and dollar flows through) and hold the run-the-business and keep-the-lights-on mandate for reliability, tech debt, and operational load.
- Lead Amazon Prime Day readiness year over year, Button's largest revenue event: capacity planning, load testing, and Go/No-Go across core services, scaling infrastructure up to 12x baseline at 100% uptime.
- Served as incident commander through Fetch's Super Bowl, holding the platform at 2.6x its planned peak with errors within normal limits. Rebuilt on-call, severity classification, and blameless postmortems from scratch, sustaining 99.99% uptime and cutting MTTR.
- Cut core-engineering interrupts approximately 30% by standing up a Support-to-Data-to-Core escalation flow, converting reactive firefighting into protected delivery capacity.
- Own the order pipeline, the platform's revenue path at 600K+ orders per day. Drove autoscaling, Aurora migrations, and ComStore and Django modernization, and led the release-confidence program (staging parity plus end-to-end testing) that cut release cycles from roughly two months to three weeks. Backed cost discipline including a single AWS saving of approximately \$70K per year.
- Sponsored internal read-only LLM tooling (a Sam's Club order debugger and a CSV validator) that cut manual triage load, built with tightly scoped tools to prevent hallucination. Championed AI-augmented delivery; org-wide, Claude-attributed code reached approximately 45% of lines shipped and two-thirds of merged pull requests.

- Stood up Button's partner-support function from scratch, taking support from fully ad hoc to a structured, SLA-backed operation. Architected the Salesforce-to-Zendesk-to-Jira model with Zendesk as source of truth for routing, prioritization, and SLAs, and formed a Support Engineering team to own it.
- Defined tiered SLAs and the incident priority matrix across strategic partners (Uber, Amazon, Best Buy, Sam's Club, Fetch): P0 acknowledged in under 15 minutes and 30-minute response for Tier 1, plus the escalation decision tree across Solutions Engineering, Data, and on-call.
- Solutions Engineering landed and scaled integrations across Amazon, Walmart, Best Buy, Target, Sam's Club, Nike, Lululemon, Puma, Samsung, Expedia, Marriott, Uber One, Lyft, Disney+, and StubHub, including the Sam's Club Glass and mParticle migration.
- Cut enterprise integration onboarding time 30% and raised revenue per integration 20% by standardizing the integration path and removing bespoke per-partner engineering.
- Led formation and initial delivery of Button's retail media product, setting roadmap and release plan with product and revenue and shipping initial releases with NY Post, Forbes, and BuzzFeed.
- Act as engineering manager, product manager, and scrum lead for the org: roadmap, backlog prioritization, quarterly capacity planning, and full Agile cadence across multiple squads, plus the feasibility gate between Revenue, Product, and Engineering.
- Built the team I now run and lead through managers as well as individual contributors, with a director-track Solutions Engineering leader reporting to me. Raised the hiring bar, authored the career-growth ladder and design-review process, and sponsored a PERM labor certification end to end.

Founder & Principal

Digital Tide | Remote | 2023 - Present

Independent consultancy where I found and run businesses end to end across product, engineering, business, growth, and design. I stand companies up (entity, cloud, email, go-to-market), build the applications, and take on brand and design work where it is mine to do.

- Sanbar (sanbar.us): built the client's entire technical foundation including GCP and AWS infrastructure, DNS, email and identity, deployment pipeline, and production site.
- That Paleo Chick (thatpaleochick.com): built the business, not just the site, with AWS infrastructure, email, automated social content and scheduling via Postiz, and affiliate monetization, running as a near-fully automated operation.
- Greedy: ran project management for the full site redesign (scope, vendors, launch) and own social marketing and paid acquisition, including a Meta Ad Library-driven competitive playbook and AI-generated video creative.
- Charter: designed and built an invoicing application end to end covering auth, billing entities, invoice generation, and payment tracking.
- Designed the brand and logo for Digital Tide and That Paleo Chick, and the UI/UX for the applications shipped.
- Digital Tide (digitalti.de): applied the same playbook to my own firm, plus the engineering standards clients inherit: Linear-first delivery, GitHub Actions CI, and Slack automation.

IT Manager, Engineering Chapter

Centene Corporation | St. Louis, MO | January 2019 - October 2020

- Led 25 engineers across seven cross-functional Agile teams delivering member-facing web and mobile applications and new health-plan implementations.
- Built the standard engineering process layer for all web and mobile matrix teams and defined the metrics leadership used for staffing and prioritization.
- Created a Developer Assessment Framework that made role expectations explicit, contributing to top 10% employee engagement across web leadership teams.

IT Manager, Member AI & Mobile; Senior Application Software Engineer

Centene Corporation | St. Louis, MO | September 2014 - January 2019

- Built and led the cross-functional team that shipped a self-service AI health assistant, reducing call-center volume, and established the SDLC framework for the inherited application.
- Delivered 20+ mobile applications across iOS and Android, launched care management in the Florida market, and standardized mobile build, release, and compliance for state contracts.
- As Senior Engineer: shipped OAuth 2.0 via API Gateway, migrated the organization from SVN to Git, and mentored approximately 10 engineers.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer / Web Producer, Centene, 2013 - 2014
Team Lead, Visual Design, N-Depth Solutions, 2008 - 2013
Web Developer, Clear Pages, 2007 - 2008

EDUCATION

A.A.S., Multimedia & Web Design, St. Charles Community College, 2004 - 2007

CERTIFICATIONS

ITIL Foundation, AXELOS
Leadership Development Program, Centene